

Franco Modigliani (1918–2003)

Modigliani, an outspoken antifascist and a Jew, left his native Italy in 1938 to escape the fascist dictatorship of Mussolini. He lived in Paris before settling in the US, where he taught economics. He went on to become a professor at the Massachusetts Institute of Technology. In 1985, he won the Nobel Prize for his study of savings and financial markets.

Dambisa Moyo (1969–)

A Zambian-born international economist now based in New York, Moyo is best known for her controversial opposition to aid for developing countries, expressed in her first book *Dead Aid*. She moved to the US to study, and later got her Ph.D. in Economics at Oxford. After working for the World Bank and Goldman Sachs she has devoted her time to writing and speaking about development and international economics, but is also on the board of several major companies, banks, and charities.

John Forbes Nash (1928–2015)

Joint winner of the 1994 Nobel Prize in Economic Science, John Nash was a brilliant mathematician whose work in “game theory” helped to explain the way that we interact with one another when making economic decisions. The Hollywood film *A Beautiful Mind* was based on his life, especially his struggles with schizophrenia.

Elinor Ostrom (1933–2012)

Elinor Ostrom was the first, and so far only, woman to win a Nobel Memorial Prize in Economic Sciences (which she shared with Oliver Williamson in 2009). She was born in Los Angeles, California, and after studying at UCLA taught at Indiana and Arizona State Universities, where she became known for her work on politics, government, and economics, and especially the production of public goods and services.

Vilfredo Pareto (1848–1923)

Although born in France, the son of a French mother and Italian father, Pareto was brought up in Italy, where he studied engineering and became a civil engineer. He later developed an interest in economics and sociology, and at the age of 45 became a professor of political economy at Lausanne University. He is best known for his work on welfare economics and income distribution, including the “Pareto efficiency” named after him.

Arthur Pigou (1877–1959)

A student of Alfred Marshall at Cambridge University, English economist Arthur Pigou developed the idea of extra taxes, called “Pigovian taxes” on businesses that create externalities, causing harm or cost to others. He became Professor of Political Economy at Cambridge in 1908, and remained there until 1943.

Robert Putnam (1941–)